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Question

The following text is from Mark Haber's 2022 novel *Saint Sebastian's Abyss*. The narrator and Schmidt are both art critics.

When my first wife admitted to Schmidt over dinner that she didn't find art, painting in particular, especially compelling, Schmidt winced, set down his fork, and sighed dramatically; he then excused himself, explaining an appointment he'd forgotten about had suddenly and inexplicably been remembered, while making it abundantly clear there was no appointment at all.

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Based on the text, what is notable about Schmidt's behavior?

Answer

- A. Schmidt is only given to theatrical behavior when in the company of the narrator and his first wife.
- B. Schmidt's absentmindedness regarding his schedule is uncharacteristic of him.
- C. Schmidt's departure is occasioned by the resumption of a previous disagreement with the narrator's first wife about a particular painting.
- D. Schmidt conveys his feelings about one of his dining companions without explicitly stating them.